

Julian Yutong Zhu

Product / UX designer working across AI interactions, service workflows and design systems. RCA MDes Design Futures graduate with research, client-project delivery and hands-on digital prototyping experience.

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DESIGN EXPERIENCE

RCA-Sodexo industry collaboration | Service Designer (academic project) | Jan 2025 - Jul 2025

- Designed SmaTaste through an RCA industry collaboration, translating dining research into Smart Taste Index UI, personalised recommendation flows and B2B/B2C service concepts.
- Conducted small-scale user interviews and clickable-prototype reviews; worked with Sodexo supply-chain and design stakeholders to refine requirements and the proposal.
- Contributed UX and AI workflow design in a four-person team and discussed design details with Sodexo engineers for follow-on development. SmaTaste won third prize in the RCA and Sodexo challenge.

SKG Studio | Web Designer, contract | 2025 - 2026

- Delivered skgplus.cn and a publishing workflow for 170+ works, working directly with the CEO, content lead and creators on requirements, information architecture and responsive design.
- Connected Google Sheets content with an automated publishing pipeline; reused the design system and components to deliver a competition website in three weeks.

HUAWEI Cloud Image Studio | Co-designer, Meta Station project | 2021 - 2022

- Co-designed an interactive mobile-theme concept with day/night lock-screen states, icon assets, wallpapers and watch-face materials; prepared editable visual and theme-delivery assets with a collaborator.

ByteDance commercial workshop | Visual Designer, AR effects project | 2022 - 2023

- Created custom AR effects and 3D assets through the TikTok commercial-workshop pipeline, covering face, atmosphere and interaction concepts.

RESEARCH

Co-author, Speculative Design Meets AI: Exploring Creative Dynamics Through Co-speculative Workshops. HCII 2025, Springer LNCS 16346, pp. 91-102. DOI: 10.1007/978-3-032-13187-4_7.

SELECTED EXPLORATORY PROJECTS

Poetic Form, 2024: Designed a Human-AI workflow using structured prompts, ComfyUI imagery and image-to-3D probes for an exhibition presentation.

Wildfire Whispers, 2022-2023: Explored MODIS wildfire-data visualisation in TouchDesigner and gesture/projection interaction. Academic exploration, not a commercial product.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Acosta Europe | Passenger Ambassador, full-time | Jul 2026 - Present

- Provide English and Mandarin support to international passengers at Heathrow Terminal 5, including wayfinding, shopping assistance and practical journey guidance.

RCA Executive Education | Programme Facilitator, casual | Jul 2025 - Jan 2026 delivery

- Supported three multi-day programmes for 150+ international delegates; coordinated travel and logistics for 9-12 visiting lecturers per cohort, guest briefings, group visits and feedback translation.

EDUCATION

Royal College of Art | MDes, Design Futures | Sep 2024 - Aug 2025

Sichuan Fine Arts Institute | BFA, Digital Media | Aug 2020 - Jun 2024

SKILLS

Design: Product and UX design, user interviews, research synthesis, user flows, information architecture, interaction design, design systems, clickable prototyping and stakeholder collaboration.

Tools and implementation: Figma, Adobe Creative Cloud, Cinema 4D, ComfyUI, TouchDesigner, Google Sheets and Make.com.

Languages: English (IELTS 7.0) / Mandarin (native).